Test Strategy and Approach

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Test Approach

Test Policy

A Test Policy is a high level document and is at the top of the hierarchy of the Test Documentation structure. It represents the testing philosophy of the company as a whole and provides a direction on which the testing department should adhere to and follow.

Test Strategy

A test strategy is an outline that describes the testing approach of the software development cycle. It is created to inform project managers, testers, and developers about some key issues of the testing process.

Test Approach

A test approach is the test strategy implementation of a project, defines how testing would be carried out.

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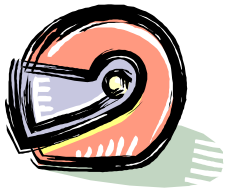
Test Procedure (1)

- Test approaches can be classified wrt. the time, when the test design was started
  - Preventive approach → Design tests as early as possible
  - Reactive Approach →Design tests after programming

- Typical approaches or strategies contain
  - Analytic approaches e.g. Risk-based tests with focus on the domains with the highest risks of defects (analysis of the test object)
  - Model-based analysis e.g. Stochastic testing, using statistic information about failure rates (e.g. reliability expansion rate model) or system usage (e.g. usage profiles)
  - Methodological approaches e.g. Defect-based testing (Error Guessing) where testing is based on check lists (experience-based) and quality-characteristic testing

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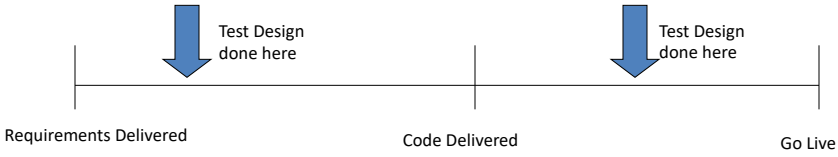
Test Approaches



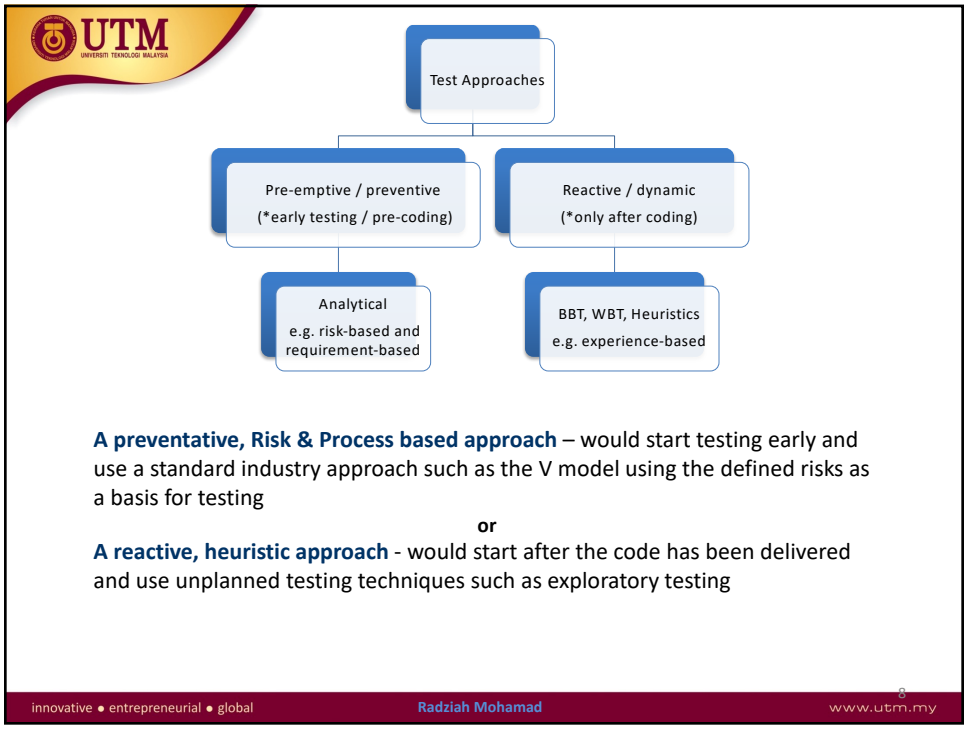


Preventive

Reactive



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Test Approaches
Pre-emptive / preventive
(*early testing / pre-coding)
Reactive / dynamic
(*only after coding)
Analytical
e.g. risk-based and requirement-based
BBT, WBT, Heuristics
e.g. experience-based
A preventative, Risk & Process based approach – would start testing early and use a standard industry approach such as the V model using the defined risks as a basis for testing
or
A reactive, heuristic approach - would start after the code has been delivered and use unplanned testing techniques such as exploratory testing
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